

Dutch, Englund and Rare First Moves

A compact survival kit for every unusual reply to 1.d4

THE PROMISE

Remove the surprise premium from rare defenses while keeping study time proportional to how often they occur.

COURSE VOLUME 09 OF 10

SEE THE POSITION | RECALL THE PLAN | CALCULATE THE MOVE

What this volume should change

- Use one fianchetto shell against Leningrad, Stonewall, and Classical Dutch structures.
- Meet the Englund Gambit with a safe accepted line that avoids the famous queen trap.
- Handle English Defense, 1...Nc6, 1...b5, 1...d6, 1...g6, and flexible 1...e6/1...c6 orders.
- Return to the main repertoire whenever Black transposes instead of inventing a new branch.

STUDY METHOD

Learn each chapter in three layers: first the trigger and plan, then the short main line, then Black's branches. Hide the page and reconstruct the line on a board. Do not memorize notation without the position's purpose.

Inside this volume

01	The Dutch fianchetto shell
02	Leningrad Dutch
03	Stonewall Dutch
04	Classical Dutch
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06	English Defense and 1...b6
07	1...Nc6 and flexible knight defenses
08	1...b5 and remaining first moves

Original instructional synthesis. Move sequences were legality-checked with python-chess and critical choices were reviewed with Stockfish 18. Opening-frequency context was checked against the Lichess opening explorer in September 2026. Engines verify tactics; the explanations and training design are the course's teaching layer. Diagrams use Colin M. L. Burnett's Cburnett piece artwork as distributed by Lichess under GPLv2+.

CHAPTER 01

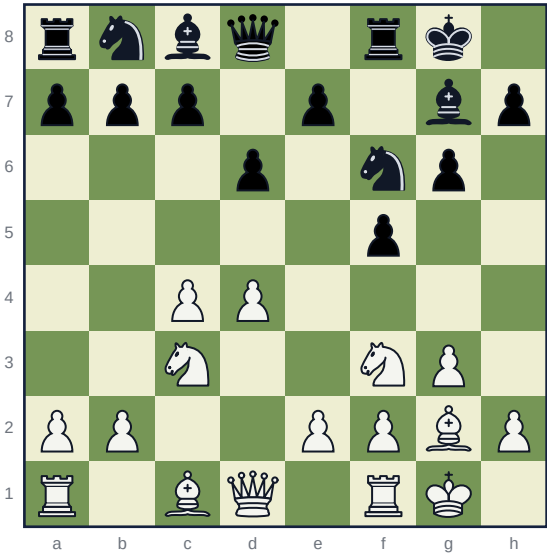
The Dutch fianchetto shell

POSITION TRIGGER

1.d4 f5: Black controls e4 and announces kingside ambitions.

Your anchor line

1. d4 f5 2. c4 Nf6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7 5. Nc3 O-O 6. Nf3 d6 7. O-O



Repertoire position after the main line

Why this setup works

White fianchettoes to challenge the long diagonal and makes Black's e5 break harder. Nc3 and Nf3 support d5/e5; castling completes a low-maintenance setup that works against all Dutch families. The next decision depends on Black's pawn triangle: ...g6 creates Leningrad play, ...e6/d5 creates Stonewall, and ...e6/Be7/d6 creates Classical Dutch play.

White's plan

- Fianchetto g3/Bg2, develop both knights, and castle.
- Use d5 when Black's ...e5 break is prevented and the space gain cannot be undermined.
- Challenge e4 and the dark squares with Ne5, Qc2, and b3/Bb2 according to the structure.

What Black is trying to do

- ...e5 is Black's main central break and can open the f-file attack.
- ...Qe8-h5 and ...f4 create direct kingside threats.
- ...d6 or ...d5 chooses between Leningrad and Stonewall structures.

Branch map

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
...g6	Use the Leningrad chapter: O-O, Nc3, and d5 against ...c6/e5.

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
...e6 and ...d5	Use the Stonewall chapter: b3/Ba3 and dark-square occupation.
...e6 and ...Be7	Use the Classical chapter: Nc3, Nf3, and central pressure before ...e5.
...d6 without ...g6	Complete Nf3/O-O and watch ...e5; the shell remains valid.

MOVE-ORDER DISCIPLINE

Do not treat 1...f5 as an immediate kingside weakness to attack. Black has gained e4 control; White must complete development before exploiting the diagonal or e6 square.

MEMORY HOOK

Fianchetto first; Black's pawn triangle chooses the plan.

CHAPTER 02

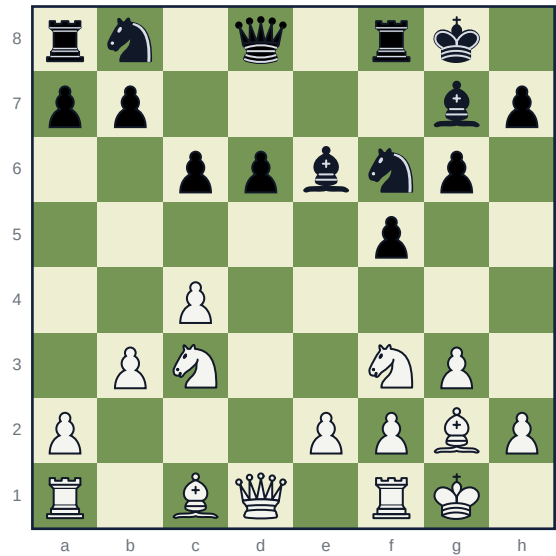
Leningrad Dutch

POSITION TRIGGER

Black combines ...f5, ...g6, ...Bg7, and ...d6, preparing ...e5.

Your anchor line

1. d4 f5 2. c4 Nf6 3. g3 g6 4. Bg2 Bg7 5. Nc3 O-O 6. Nf3 d6 7. O-O c6 8. d5 e5 9. dxe6 Bxe6 10. b3



Repertoire position after the main line

Why this setup works

White uses d5 to interfere with ...e5 and may exchange on e6 to leave a target and open the long diagonal. b3/Bb2 adds pressure to e5/g7 and supports queenside development. Black's f-pawn gives space but weakens e6 and the king. The position remains dynamic; White must watch ...Ne4, ...Na6-c5, and queen attacks on the kingside.

White's plan

- Use d5 when it cramps ...e5 and cannot be attacked immediately by ...c6.
- Develop b3/Bb2 and use Qc2 to pressure e4/e6.
- Trade Black's dark bishop when it reduces kingside attacking potential without surrendering central control.

What Black is trying to do

- ...e5 is the freeing break and source of kingside space.
- ...Qe8-h5 can create direct threats against h2.
- ...Na6-c5 and ...Ne4 centralize pieces before the attack.

Branch map

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
...c6	d5 interferes with ...e5 and gains space.

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
...e5	dxe6 when it opens the bishop and leaves e6 weak; otherwise preserve the wedge.
...Qe8	Qc2 and e4 control; count ...Qh5 tactics before queenside play.
...Na6	b3/Bb2 and Qc2; control c5/e4.

MOVE-ORDER DISCIPLINE

The d5 advance is good because it obstructs Black's intended break, not because space is automatically valuable. Calculate ...c6 and ...e6 counterplay.

MEMORY HOOK

Stop ...e5 with d5, open the long diagonal, and monitor queen-to-h5 threats.

CHAPTER 03

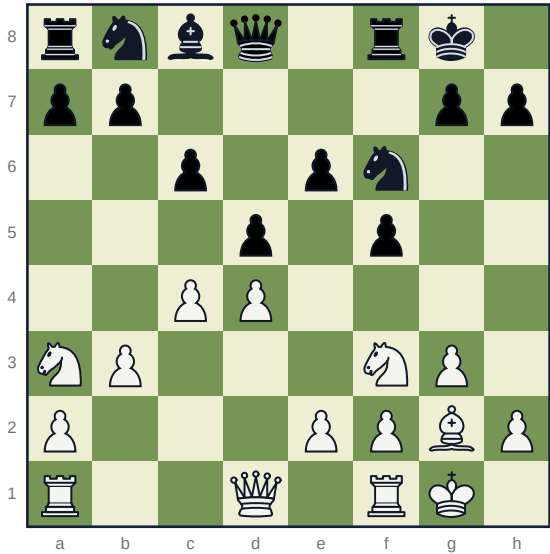
Stonewall Dutch

POSITION TRIGGER

Black builds pawns on f5, e6, d5, and c6, creating a locked light-square chain.

Your anchor line

1. d4 f5 2. c4 Nf6 3. g3 e6 4. Bg2 d5 5. Nf3 c6 6. O-O Bd6 7. b3 O-O 8. Ba3 Bxa3 9. Nxa3



Repertoire position after the main line

Why this setup works

The Stonewall controls e4 but concedes dark squares, especially e5 and c5. b3 and Ba3 seek to exchange Black's active d6 bishop, an important attacking piece. White places a knight on e5 and uses Nc3-d3 or Nbd2. Pawn breaks with f3/e4 or cxd5 are prepared only after pieces dominate the holes.

White's plan

- Exchange the d6 bishop with Ba3 when it removes Black's best kingside attacker.
- Occupy e5 with a knight and support it with Nbd2 or Qc2.
- Use f3/e4 or cxd5 only when the dark-square control makes the opening favorable.

What Black is trying to do

- ...Bd6 and ...O-O create threats against h2.
- ...Qe7, ...Nbd7, and ...Ne4 build a kingside attack around the e4 outpost.
- ...b6 and ...Bb7 challenge White's long diagonal and support c5/e4.

Branch map

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
...d5 and ...c6	b3 and Ba3 target the d6 bishop.

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
...Bd6	Ba3 or Bf4; exchange the attacking bishop when timing is safe.
...Ne4	Nbd2 and f3 only after checking h2 tactics.
...b6	Bb2 and Ne5; keep pressure on the dark-square holes.

MOVE-ORDER DISCIPLINE

Do not attack the f5 pawn before controlling e4 and king safety. The Stonewall is defeated by squares and piece exchanges, not a pawn raid.

MEMORY HOOK

Exchange Bd6, occupy e5, prepare the break from dark-square control.

CHAPTER 04

Classical Dutch

POSITION TRIGGER

Black uses ...e6, ...Be7, ...O-O, and ...d6, often preparing ...Qe8 and ...e5.

Your anchor line

1. d4 f5 2. c4 Nf6 3. g3 e6 4. Bg2 Be7 5. Nf3 O-O 6. O-O d6 7. Nc3 Qe8 8. Re1 Qg6 9. e4



Repertoire position after the main line

Why this setup works

White develops quietly, then uses Re1 and e4 to challenge Black's central claim. The move ...Qe8 often signals ...Qh5 or ...e5, so White must calculate kingside threats before opening the center. When e4 works, the f5 pawn can become a hook and the g2 bishop gains scope.

White's plan

- Use Nc3 and Re1 to prepare e4.
- Open the center while Black's queen spends tempi on the kingside, provided checks are controlled.
- After e4, choose exf5 or e5 based on which diagonal and file opens favorably.

What Black is trying to do

- ...Qe8-h5 attacks h2 and supports ...e5.
- ...Bd8-a5 or ...Ne4 centralizes pieces around the king.
- ...e5 can free Black completely if White's central challenge is late.

Branch map

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
...Qe8	Re1 prepares e4 while adding central support.

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
...Qg6	e4 when checks on g2/h2 are controlled.
...Ne4	Qc2 or Nxe4; remove the outpost before opening.
...e5	dxe5 or e4 according to whether the f-file becomes dangerous.

MOVE-ORDER DISCIPLINE

A queen sortie can be an attack, not wasted time. Before 9.e4, calculate ...fxe4 and every queen check.

MEMORY HOOK

Classical: Re1-e4 before Black achieves ...e5, but checks come first.

CHAPTER 05

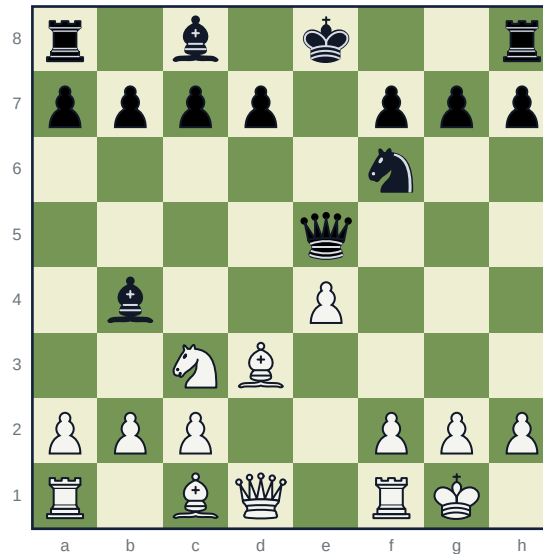
England Gambit without the trap

POSITION TRIGGER

1.d4 e5: Black attacks d4 immediately and offers a pawn for rapid queen play.

Your anchor line

1. d4 e5 2. dxe5 Nc6 3. Nf3 Qe7 4. Nc3 Nxe5 5. Nxe5 Qxe5 6. e4 Nf6 7. Bd3 Bb4 8. O-O



Repertoire position after the main line

Why this setup works

White accepts the pawn but prioritizes development. The famous trap begins when White's bishop goes to f4 and Black checks with ...Qb4+, then raids b2. The repertoire uses 4.Nc3, allowing exchanges that leave White with a broad center and easy development. Returning the gambit pawn is a success because Black's compensation disappears with the queens and minor pieces.

White's plan

- Develop Nf3 and Nc3; allow exchanges rather than defending the extra pawn with slow moves.
- Use e4, Bd3, and O-O to claim the center and king safety.
- Trade queens when it ends Black's initiative on favorable terms.

What Black is trying to do

- ...Qe7 pressures e5 and may create a check on b4.
- ...Qb4+ followed by ...Qxb2 is the main practical trap.
- ...Bb4 pins Nc3 and increases central pressure while White's king is uncastled.

Branch map

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
1...e5	2.dxe5. Accept, but do not promise to keep the pawn.

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
2...Nc6	3.Nf3 Qe7 4.Nc3 avoids the Bf4/Qb4+ trap.
4...Nxe5	5.Nxe5 Qxe5 6.e4; use the queen exchange and center.
...Bb4	Bd3 and castle; break the pin with development.

MOVE-ORDER DISCIPLINE

Do not play the automatic 2.c4, and do not play 4.Bf4 unless you know the exact trap. 4.Nc3 is the course's safe anchor.

MEMORY HOOK

Accept, Nf3-Nc3, exchange the attacker, build e4 and castle.

CHAPTER 06

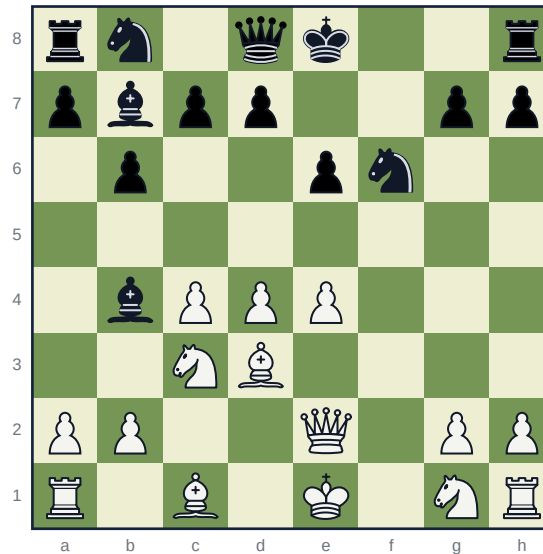
English Defense and 1...b6

POSITION TRIGGER

Black fianchettoes the queen bishop and attacks e4 before occupying the center.

Your anchor line

1. d4 e6 2. c4 b6 3. Nc3 Bb7 4. e4 Bb4 5. Bd3 f5 6. Qe2 Nf6 7. f3 fxe4 8. fxe4



Repertoire position after the main line

Why this setup works

White builds a broad center but must support e4 against the b7 bishop and ...f5. Bd3 develops and Qe2 reinforces e4; f3 is used only when Black's ...f5 makes the center tactical. White may accept an awkward-looking pawn structure because the open f-file and space compensate, but king safety remains urgent.

White's plan

- Build Nc3/e4/Bd3 and support e4 with Qe2 before Black strikes.
- Use f3 only when it meets a concrete ...f5 challenge.
- Castle queenside or short according to opened files; do not decide before the center resolves.

What Black is trying to do

- ...Bb4 pins Nc3 and increases e4 pressure.
- ...f5 is the defining break and can open the f-file.
- ...Nf6 and ...O-O-O may create rapid pressure against White's center.

Branch map

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
1...e6 2.c4 b6	3.Nc3 Bb7 4.e4. Occupy the center.

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
4...Bb4	5.Bd3. Develop and support e4.
...f5	Qe2 and f3 if needed; resolve the central attack.
...Nf6	e5 or f3 according to whether advancing gains a stable space wedge.

MOVE-ORDER DISCIPLINE

A broad pawn center invites attack. Every pawn move must be paired with development; do not defend e4 three times while the king remains on e1.

MEMORY HOOK

Broad center, Qe2 support, answer ...f5 concretely, then secure the king.

CHAPTER 07

1...Nc6 and flexible knight defenses

POSITION TRIGGER

Black develops the queen knight without committing a central pawn.

Your anchor line

1. d4 Nc6 2. Nf3 d5 3. c4 e6 4. Nc3 Nf6 5. Bf4 Be7 6. e3 O-O



Repertoire position after the main line

Why this setup works

White uses Nf3 before c4 to avoid an immediate ...e5 fork on d4/c4 and to keep the Englund-style tactics under control. After ...d5, c4 returns to the Queen's Gambit structure. If Black plays ...e5 instead, d5 can gain space, while dxe5 is possible when development supports it. The early knight may be misplaced in front of the c-pawn, but White should exploit that through central play rather than chasing it.

White's plan

- Use 2.Nf3 to stabilize d4 and observe Black's center.
- After ...d5, play c4 and transpose to QGD/Chigorin logic.
- After ...e5, compare d5 and dxe5 by which move preserves development and space.

What Black is trying to do

- ...e5 attacks d4 and may create an immediate central fork.
- ...d5 transposes to Chigorin or QGD structures with the knight already on c6.
- ...Bg4 can pin Nf3 before White challenges the center.

Branch map

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
1...Nc6	2.Nf3. Stabilize before c4.

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
2...d5	3.c4 and use the Chigorin/QGD map.
2...e5	3.d5 Nce7 4.e4; gain space with development next.
...Bg4	Be2 or Nbd2; break the pin before central expansion.

MOVE-ORDER DISCIPLINE

The knight's unusual square is not a tactical refutation. Use the time to build a sound center and let the blocked c-pawn limit Black naturally.

MEMORY HOOK

Against ...Nc6, Nf3 first; let the black center reveal the correct map.

CHAPTER 08

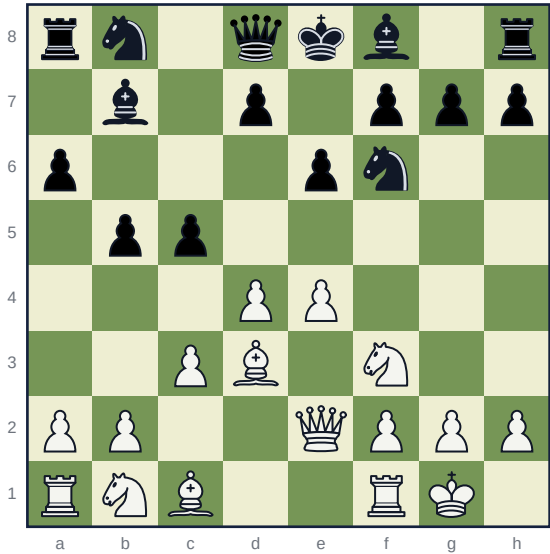
1...b5 and remaining first moves

POSITION TRIGGER

Black spends the first move on a wing pawn or a flexible shell instead of central control.

Your anchor line

1. d4 b5 2. e4 Bb7 3. Bd3 Nf6 4. Qe2 a6 5. Nf3 e6 6. O-O c5 7. c3



Repertoire position after the main line

Why this setup works

Against 1...b5, White occupies e4 before deciding on c4 because Black has conceded the center and may attack c4 with ...bxc4. Bd3, Nf3, and O-O produce a strong classical center. Against 1...d6, 1...g6, 1...e6, or 1...c6, use c4 when no forcing issue exists and transpose to the Modern, QGD, Slav, or Dutch based on Black's next pawn move.

White's plan

- Against a wing move, occupy the center with e4 and develop before attacking the pawn.
- Use c3 or c4 according to whether Black's b-pawn makes c4 a target.
- Against flexible ...d6/...g6/...e6/...c6, make normal c4 development and classify the next central commitment.

What Black is trying to do

- ...b4 can chase Nc3, which is why Nf3/Bd3 development is useful first.
- ...f5 may transpose to an English Defense or Dutch structure.
- ...c5 attacks the broad center and may turn the game into a Benoni-like structure.

Branch map

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
1...b5	2.e4. Occupy the center before choosing the c-pawn.

BLACK CHOOSES	YOUR RESPONSE AND PURPOSE
1...d6 / 1...g6	2.c4 and use Modern/King's Indian chapters.
1...e6	2.c4; classify ...d5, ...Nf6, ...f5, or ...b6.
1...c6	2.c4 d5 3.Nf3: Slav move order.

MOVE-ORDER DISCIPLINE

Do not create a separate memory tree for moves that transpose. Record the first position that differs structurally, then use the existing volume.

MEMORY HOOK

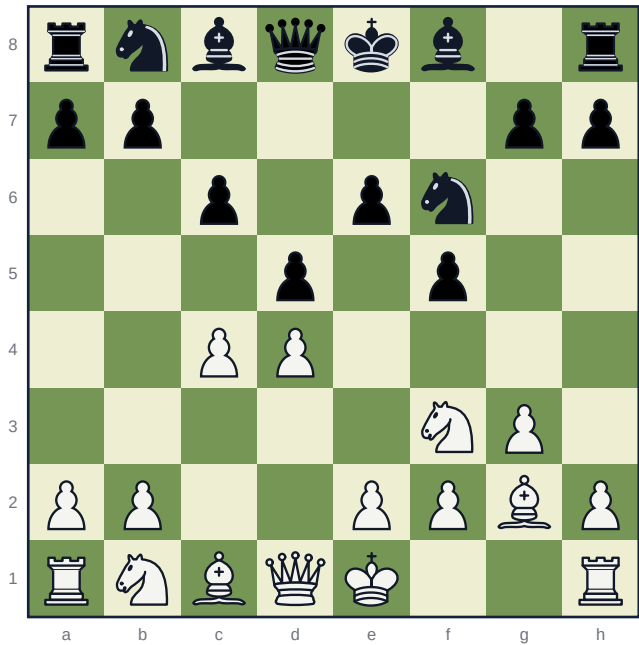
Wing move: take center. Flexible move: c4 and wait for the structural signpost.

Repertoire Test

For every position, name the opening branch, state your strategic objective, and choose a move. The answer is not only a move: it is a move attached to a reason.

TEST 01 | Dutch classification

Which Dutch family is this, and what two strategic operations define White's plan?



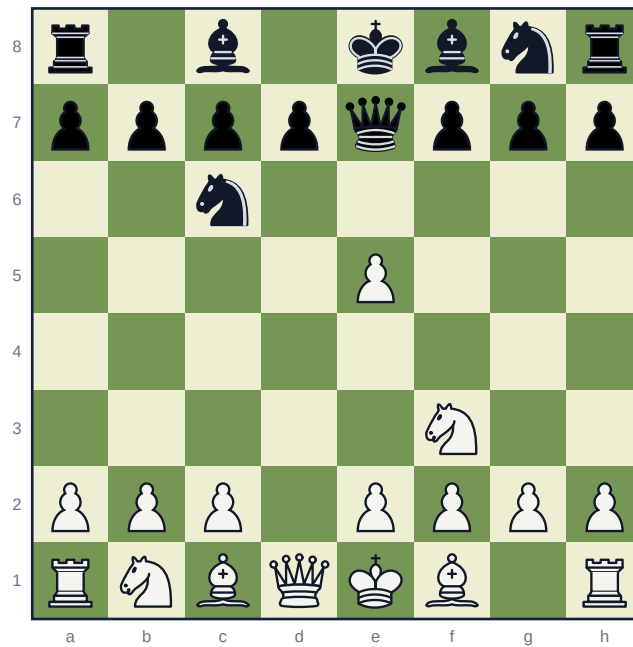
Position reached by: 1. d4 f5 2. c4 Nf6 3. g3 e6 4. Bg2 d5 5. Nf3 c6

WRITE BEFORE CHECKING

1) the cue, 2) at least two candidates, 3) Black's strongest reply, and 4) the plan you expect after the move.

TEST 02 | Avoid the Englund trap

Which fourth move keeps development simple and refuses Black's queen trap?



Position reached by: 1. d4 e5 2. dxe5 Nc6 3. Nf3 Qe7

WRITE BEFORE CHECKING

1) the cue, 2) at least two candidates, 3) Black's strongest reply, and 4) the plan you expect after the move.

TEST 03 | English Defense center

Which queen move supports e4 before the center opens?



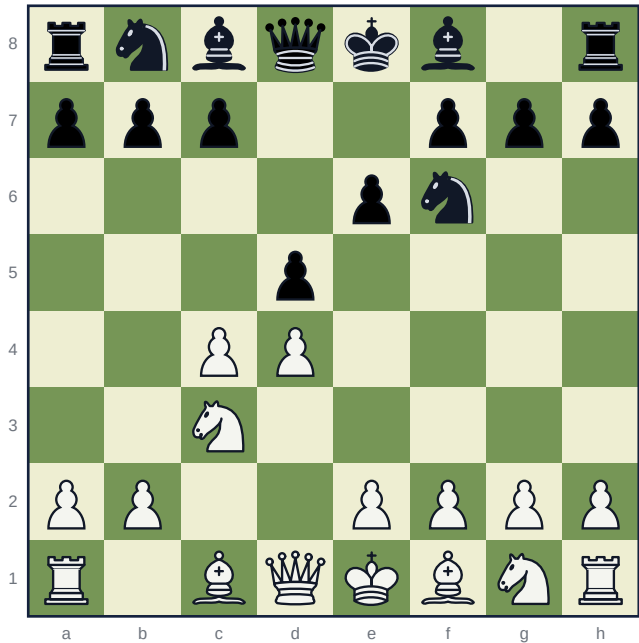
Position reached by: 1. d4 e6 2. c4 b6 3. Nc3 Bb7 4. e4 Bb4 5. Bd3 f5

WRITE BEFORE CHECKING

1) the cue, 2) at least two candidates, 3) Black's strongest reply, and 4) the plan you expect after the move.

TEST 04 | Flexible first move

Which existing course branch has Black entered?



Position reached by: 1. d4 e6 2. c4 Nf6 3. Nc3 d5

WRITE BEFORE CHECKING

1) the cue, 2) at least two candidates, 3) Black's strongest reply, and 4) the plan you expect after the move.

Repertoire Test - Answers

TEST 01 | Dutch classification

This is the Stonewall. Use b3/Ba3 to exchange Black's d6 bishop and occupy e5 with a knight. Attack the dark squares before preparing f3/e4.

TEST 02 | Avoid the Englund trap

Play 4.Nc3. After ...Nxe5, exchange on e5 and build e4. The course avoids 4.Bf4 Qb4+, the trap-heavy branch.

TEST 03 | English Defense center

Play 6.Qe2. If necessary, f3 meets ...fxe4. White must resolve the center and then secure the king.

TEST 04 | Flexible first move

This is the QGD. Play 4.cxd5 exd5 5.Bf4 and use the Exchange Variation volume.

One-Page Recall Card

Cover the right column. Read the trigger and say the memory hook. Then cover the left column and reconstruct which position produces that hook.

1.d4 f5: Black controls e4 and announces kingside ambitions.	Fianchetto first; Black's pawn triangle chooses the plan.
Black combines ...f5, ...g6, ...Bg7, and ...d6, preparing ...e5.	Stop ...e5 with d5, open the long diagonal, and monitor queen-to-h5 threats.
Black builds pawns on f5, e6, d5, and c6, creating a locked light-square chain.	Exchange Bd6, occupy e5, prepare the break from dark-square control.
Black uses ...e6, ...Be7, ...O-O, and ...d6, often preparing ...Qe8 and ...e5.	Classical: Re1-e4 before Black achieves ...e5, but checks come first.
1.d4 e5: Black attacks d4 immediately and offers a pawn for rapid queen play.	Accept, Nf3-Nc3, exchange the attacker, build e4 and castle.
Black fianchettoes the queen bishop and attacks e4 before occupying the center.	Broad center, Qe2 support, answer ...f5 concretely, then secure the king.
Black develops the queen knight without committing a central pawn.	Against ...Nc6, Nf3 first; let the black center reveal the correct map.
Black spends the first move on a wing pawn or a flexible shell instead of central control.	Wing move: take center. Flexible move: c4 and wait for the structural signpost.

SPACED REVIEW

Review today, tomorrow, after three days, after one week, and after one month. A chapter graduates only when you can reconstruct its anchor line and explain its plan without looking.

GAME TRANSFER

After every serious game, locate the first position where your memory ended. Study from that exact fork. This turns the repertoire into a living system while keeping the PDFs as the stable foundation.